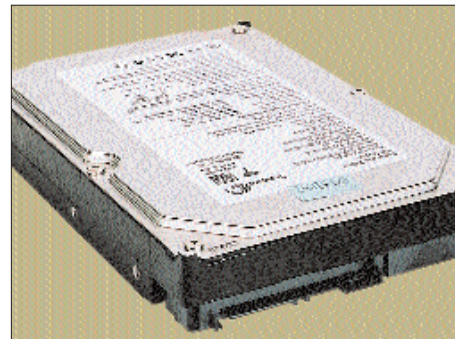


Storage

Organising Files and Folders

The number of files and folders on your hard drive increases as you keep installing programs. If the files are not properly organised, the performance of the hard drive degrades, and you will end up wasting valuable time searching for files. The best way to keep a check on this is to partition your hard drive, and allocate the partition sizes according to the number of applications that are going to be installed on the system, and the amount of data that will be stored. As far as storing files and folder goes, here are a few simple tips to follow.



- Always store all your documents and other working data on a secondary partition.
- Name a folder based on the data that is stored in it.
- File names should be such that they carry sufficient information regarding content, date created, etc.

- Keep separate folders for different kinds of files such as images, documents, and so on.
- Try not to install games, applications, and other system utilities on the main partition, since this will clutter the disk with data, and hence affect disk access time, and therefore performance.
- Over a period of time, as data gets stored and deleted, it becomes necessary to defragment the data.

Backup Strategies

You need to formulate a backup strategy based on your requirements. One of the primary decisions is the frequency of backup. For home users, where there isn't much data generated, a manual backup, as and when required, should do fine.

For small firms with about 10 to 20 employees, this won't work. Here, a systematic schedule needs to be set to make sure that the data on each computer is backed up regularly.

Moreover, the data backup schedule should not interfere with a users' regular working schedule. The best option,

therefore, is to schedule backups at night, after office hours.

The next important aspect is the size of the backup. Almost all backup software provide at least two levels of backup—full and modified. The Full option backs up all data from a specified location, irrespective of whether the data is modified, or is in its original form. This form of backup is inefficient, and consumes lots of space. Modified backup is a more sophisticated method that can let you back up only the data that has been modified, thereby saving system resources.